

Socio-Economic/Vital Statistics

- **Population Census**

- first Indian Census : 1872 (however in 1872, pop. census was conducted but it was limited in scope and coverage.)
- first Census after Independence was held in 1951.
- 2011 Census was 15th Census (counting from 1872) and 7th after Independence
- 2021 Census will be 16th Census
- Upto 1931 , 'de facto canvasser method' was used . **Since 1941 we use 'de jure canvasser method'.**
- Two methods of counting of population in Census:
 - (a) **De facto**- In this method, every person is counted at the place where he/she is actually found on the reference date of the Census.
 - (b) **De jure**- In this method, a person is counted at the place of his/her normal residence.
- Two methods of information gathering in Census:
 - (a) **Canvasser Method**- In this method, enumerators record answer on the schedules by himself.
 - (b) **Householder Method**- In this method, enumerator gives a schedule to every household and household owner fills the schedule by himself.
- In India, we use Canvasser method. Householder method is not much used in practice because of low literacy level in India.**
- Census machinery was made permanent in 1949 with the establishment of Registrar General of India (ex-officio Census Commissioner) (under MHA).
- first Registrar General of Independent India(1951): R.A. Gopaldaswami

-Census Operations in India is carried out in two phases:

- (i) Houselisting and Housing Census- During this phase, buildings and structures, residential, partly residential or non-residential are identified and listed systematically. This helps to prepare a complete and unambiguous frame for the Population Enumeration. Housing Census in India provides statistics on housing stock, availability of basic amenities in each household and condition of human settlements. This information helps in assessment of housing deficit, besides overall quality of dwellings and people living therein.
- (ii) Population Enumeration- It follows the Housing Census within a gap of six to eight months which counts each and every person in the country, Indian national or otherwise, along with her/his individual particulars and information on social, cultural, demographic, economic and other aspects.

-Act, Rules and Gazette Notifications supporting Census operations:

- i)The Census Act, 1948 ii)The Census Rules, 1990 iii) The Citizenship Act, 1955
- iv)The Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969

-Publications of OoRGI:

- i)Vital Statistics : Annual
- ii) Sample Registration Bulletin : Quarterly
- iii) Cause of Deaths(MCCD) : Annual

-Problems in Census: lack of technically qualified persons, poor response from the respondents, illiteracy of the masses, a widely scattered population, lack of adequate financial resources, etc.

-The enumerators and supervisors are mainly drawn from local school teachers, Central and State govt. officials and officials of local bodies who will be visiting every household to canvass census schedule.

-The Office of RGI is primarily responsible for the following activities:

(i) Housing & Population Census: The Census Commissioner, India is the statutory authority vested with the responsibility of conducting the Housing & Population Census in India under Census Act, 1948 and the Rules framed thereunder. Planning, coordination and supervision of the field activities; data processing; compilation, tabulation and dissemination of Census results are the primary duties of this office.

(ii) Civil Registration System (CRS): The Census Commissioner, India is also designated as Registrar General, India under the Registration of Births & Deaths (RBD) Act, 1969, which provides for the compulsory registration of births and deaths. In this role, the RGI coordinates the functioning of the civil registration and vital statistics system in the country through all States and UTs.

(iii) Sample Registration System (SRS): Implementation of Sample Registration System, wherein large scale sample survey of vital events is conducted on a half-yearly basis, is also the responsibility of the ORG&CCI. SRS is an important source of vital rates like Birth Rate, Death Rate, Infant Mortality Rate and Maternal Mortality Rate at the State level in the country.

(iv) National Population Register (NPR): In pursuance to provisions contained in Citizenship Rules, 2003 framed under the Citizenship Act, 1955, the National Population Register is prepared by collecting information relating to all persons who are usually residing in the country.

In India, the registration of births and deaths is carried out under provisions of the Registration of Births and Deaths (RBD) Act, 1969. The registration is done by the Registrar of the local area, appointed by concerned State/UT Government. Under the provisions of RBD Act, 1969, the registration of birth and death is mandatory. The events of births, still births and deaths are registered at the place of occurrence of the event i.e where the event took place. The normal period of reporting the event is 21 days from its occurrence, however, the event can be registered after the normal period under delayed registration provisions of Section 13 of the RBD Act.

- **Amendments to the RBD act, 1969**

At present, it is the state gov responsibility to maintain the data on registration on births and deaths. A Chief Registrar appointed in every state is the executive authority for the implementation of the Act. But now Centre want to amend RBD Act 1969 so that data can be maintained at national level and also the data should be shared with other authorities so that changes can be made instantly. For example, if a certain person has died then his/her driving license/passport/aadhar/NPR etc. can be immediately cancelled so that it can not be used otherwise. This is possible only if there is a central database of deaths and births. However, all the credentials need not be updated immediately (like voter list is updated at six months).

One amendment says that Chief Registrar (appointed by the State Gov) is to maintain a unified database at the state level and integrate it with the data at the national level, which the Registrar General of India maintains.

In addition, the database may be used to update the National Population Register(NPR), electoral register, adhar, ration card, passport and driving licenses database.

Birth certificate to be made mandatory for jobs, driving licence, passport, voting right

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NEW DELHI

The Union government proposes to make birth certificate a mandatory document for almost every sphere of life – admission in educational institutions, inclusion in the voter list, appointment in Central and State government jobs, issue of driving licence and passport – according to a draft Bill to amend the Registration of Birth and Death (RBD) Act, 1969.

The Bill is likely to be tabled in the Winter Session of Parliament that commences on December 7.

The proposed amend-



The database on births will be linked to electoral rolls for automatic inclusion.

ment also covers death certificates and makes it mandatory for hospitals to provide a copy of all death certificates, stating the cause of death, to the local registrar apart from the relative of the deceased.

The centrally stored data on births and deaths will be updated in real time without any need for human interface, leading to addition and deletion from the electoral roll when an individual turns 18, and after death, respectively.

Though registration of births and deaths is already compulsory under the RBD Act, 1969 and violating it is a punishable offence, the government intends to improve compliance by making the registration mandatory to access basic services.

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Birth certificates to be made mandatory

The Bill to amend the RBD Act, 1969, proposed by the Ministry of Home Affairs, states that birth certificates issued by the local registrars will be “used to prove the date and place of birth of a person born on or after the date of amendment for: admission into educational institutions; issuance of driving licence; preparation of voter list; registration of marriage; appointment in Central government, State government, local bodies and public sector undertakings, statutory bodies, autonomous bodies under Central and State government; issuance of passport and other cases as prescribed by rules.”

Suggestions included

“The draft Bill was placed in the public domain for suggestions last year. We have received comments from State governments and incorporated the required changes. The legislative department is examining the Bill, and it will then be presented for the Union Cabinet’s approval. We will try to introduce the Bill in the winter session of Parliament,” a source told *The Hindu*.

The source added that since the upcoming session has only 17 sittings, the discussions on the Bill could be taken up in the next session.

“Provisions exist for compulsory registration of births and deaths but after the law is amended, it will be mandatory to produce birth and death certificates for myriad purposes. The database will be linked to electoral rolls. When a person turns 18, the name will be included in the voters’ list and after a person has died, the name will be deleted from the rolls. The entire process will be online,” the source said.

The Hindu first reported on October 27, 2021 that the draft amendments would enable the Registrar General of India (RGI) under the MHA to “maintain database of registered birth and deaths at the national level”, even though such data is maintained by State governments or municipal bodies. As reported, the birth and death database at the national level that will be available with the RGI may be used to update the Population Register, the Electoral Register, and the Aadhaar, ration card, passport and driving licence databases.

The MHA is upgrading the Civil Registration System (CRS) to enable registration of births and deaths in real time with minimum human interface.

If the amendments are implemented, the Centre could use the data to update the National Population Register (NPR) that was first prepared in 2010 and revised through door-to-door enumeration in 2015. The NPR already has a database of 119 crore residents and under the Citizenship Rules, 2003, it is the first step towards the creation of a National Register of Citizens (NRC).

- The main sources of data on vital events in India are Civil Registration System (CRS), Sample Registration System (SRS) and Population Census. Though the Population Census is the main source of information on population and its characteristics; however, being a decennial exercise, it does not provide the measure of changes in population from year to year. The measures of fertility and mortality derived from Census are centered on the midpoint of the decade and as such do not provide yearly change in the population. Of the other two sources of vital statistics for getting the vital rates on a regular basis, the SRS has been designed to provide reliable estimates at National and State level. Robust estimates of vital rates at District level on an annual basis through sample survey are difficult to obtain on account of prohibitively large sample size and variety of resultant factors such as controlling of non-sampling errors etc. CRS is thus the only source for providing vital rates at district level. Rather, a complete CRS can provide these rates at all administrative levels.
- The Civil Registration System (CRS) may be defined as a unified process of continuous, permanent, compulsory and universal recording of the vital events and characteristics thereof, as per legal requirements in the country. In India, the Civil Registration System covers registration of births and deaths. Civil registration system provides the best source of information on the vital rates at all levels. Ensuring cent percent coverage of vital events by registration machinery can help in getting the critical vital statistics, equally important for planning and research. Therefore, emphasis should also be given to the proper monitoring of the activities under the system. Civil registration system is considered to be complete if it covers 100 per cent of all births and deaths taking place within a country or area.

- The registration records are primarily useful for their value as legal documents and secondarily as the source of vital statistics. Civil registration as a source of vital statistics is relatively less expensive, as the statistics generated from the registration records are the by-products of an essential administrative process. The registration records can also generate current and continuous statistics, which can be more accurate than any other method of data collection apart from being a continuous source of such data. However, the accuracy of the vital statistics obtained through the registration system depends much on the completeness and promptness with which events are registered and the correctness of the information in the registration records. The improvement in the system of registration of births and deaths is critically dependent on the importance given by the respective States and District administrations to this work and regular monitoring by them. Besides, the level of awareness among the general public about the utility of birth or death certificate is also equally and crucially important.
- Lack of awareness about the need and importance of registration among the general public and lack of procedural knowledge among the registration functionaries is one of the reasons for low levels of registration in the country. In order to make the public aware about the need and importance of registration, the State governments had undertaken various publicity measures through various means with their own funds by printing of posters, cloth banners, pamphlets, leaflets on the importance of registration of births and deaths. Radio talks were also arranged on the importance of registration of births and deaths, advertisements were published in leading newspapers.

☐ **Linguistic Survey of India**

- conducted by Language Division, office of Registrar General of India (MHA)
- The primary objective of the present Linguistic Survey of India is to present an updated linguistic scenario.
- It will also provide necessary inputs to the social/educational planners in respective States for their planning to attain the envisaged goals.
- The Census of India has been the richest source of language data collected and published at the successive decennial censuses for more than a century.
- Mother tongue is the language spoken in childhood by the person's mother to the person. If the mother died in infancy, the language mainly spoken in the person's home in childhood will be the mother tongue.
- The presentation of the language tables has been progressively improved in terms of lucidity, detail to make it more comprehensible besides being user-friendly.